

Getting rid of waste

The kidneys release a constant dribble of urine at all times of the day. This urine passes into a stretchy muscular bag—the bladder—where it is stored until we feel the need to release it. Water lost from the body in urine is replaced by the water in food and drink.

Filling and emptying

The bladder's exit is normally closed by two rings of muscle called sphincters. As the bladder fills up, a person will feel the need to urinate (go to the bathroom). The sphincters relax and urine is squeezed out by the bladder's muscular wall.

